Helen Webley-Brown

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Education

M.S. in Political Science, Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) — Cambridge, MA, Expected Jan 2025

- **Concentrations:** American Politics, Quantitative Methods **[GPA: 4.9/5.0]**
- **Coursework:** Causal Inference, Regression, Survey Experiments (Design, Analysis), Text-as-Data, Webscraping, Public Opinion, Policing, Algorithmic Fairness, Social Policy

B.A. in Political Science, Washington University — St. Louis, MO, May 2022

- **Honours:** Danforth Scholar, Phi Beta Kappa, College Honours **[GPA: 3.97/4.0]**
- **Coursework:** Data Analytics in Python, GIS, Policy Analysis, Critical Data Studies

International Baccalaureate, Ashcroft Technology Academy **[Points: 42/45]** — London, England, May 2018

13 GCSEs, Kingsdale Foundation School **[Grades: 11 A*, 2A]** — May 2016

Experience

Independent Student Researcher, MIT Department of Political Science — Cambridge, MA, Aug 2022 – Present

- Designed and fielded 3 survey experiments on open data, police, and immigration
- Regularly conduct literature reviews, clean data, and prepare replicable R code

Research Assistant, MIT Department of Political Science (Prof. Ariel White) — Cambridge, MA, May 2023 – Aug 2023

- Used Sequential Monte Carlo algorithm to analyse impact of prison gerrymandering reforms on legislative outcomes
- Presented at *Midwest Political Science Association* Conference, 2024

Summer Research Fellow, Stanford Regulation, Evaluation, and Governance Lab — Remote, June 2022 – Aug 2022

- Performed content analysis of 25 federal agencies' equity action plans
- Analysed government data minimisation policies, and its impact on bias assessments

Research Intern, Surveillance Technology Oversight Project — Remote, Jan 2022 – May 2022

- Produced two reports on emerging surveillance technologies' impact on civil rights
- Created data visualisation of racial disparities in ShotSpotter technology deployment

Data Analysis and Research Intern, The Bail Project — St. Louis, MO, June 2021 – Aug 2021

- Surveyed 43 clients and conducted 3 interviews to write report on socio-economic impacts of pretrial electronic monitoring
- Performed data fidelity checks on Salesforce reports with 900+ unique client records

Government Affairs Intern, Human Rights Campaign — Remote, Jan 2021 – April 2021

- Coded 506 cities' LGBTQ+ police liaison policies for HRC's Municipal Equality Index
- Tracked politicians' votes and bill sponsorships for HRC's Congressional Scorecard

Public Affairs and Communications Intern, Hanbury Strategy — London, England, June 2020 – Sept 2020

- Researched post-Covid infrastructure policies for polling team developing survey
- Drafted client op-eds, government consultation responses, and stakeholder maps
- Synthesised key developments in fintech and e-transport sectors to write daily briefings

Publications

Gupta, A., Wu, V., **Webley-Brown, H.**, King, J., Ho, D. (2023). The Privacy-Bias Tradeoff: Data Minimization and Racial Disparity Assessments in U.S. Government. In Proceedings of the ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT) — June 2023

- Best Paper Award at FAccT, 2023
- Student Paper Award from Future of Privacy Forum, 2023

Webley-Brown, H., Sipek, A., Buoymaster, K., Shivalkar, J., Owen, W., Manis, E. (2022). ShotSpotter and the Misfires of Gunshot Detection Technology. Surveillance Technology Oversight Project — July 2022

Loshkajian, N., Van Doran, S., Melendi, J., Saran, S., **Webley-Brown, H.**, Manis, E. (2022). Privatizing The Surveillance State: How Police Foundations Undermine Rule of Law. Surveillance Technology Oversight Project — Dec 2022

Projects

Article: Don't Shoot The Messenger: Do Open Data Initiatives Moderate the Effect of Police Violence News on Trust in Police? — Ongoing

Article: We've Got Democracy at Home: Resident Council Emergence in Public Housing Developments — Ongoing

Article: Why Watch The Watchers? Frame Utilization In Community Control Over Police Surveillance (CCOPS) Legislation — Ongoing

Website: Legal Lark — May 2021 – May 2022

- Managed team of 4 to create website on e-carceration and juvenile justice
- Built resource bank, designed infographics, and wrote articles on youth incarceration

Technical Skills

LaTeX, R and R Studio, ArcGIS, QGIS, Qualtrics, Microsoft Office Suite, Google Workspace, Survey/Polling (Prolific, Lucid)